

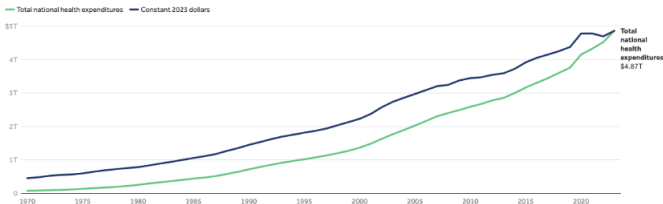
Federal & State Health Policy Landscapes

January 15, 2026

Federal Health Policy Landscape

U.S. Health Spending

Total national health expenditures, 1970-2023

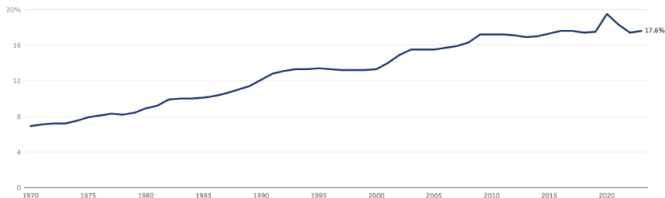


Note: A constant dollar is an inflation adjusted value used to compare dollar values from one period to another.

Source: KFF analysis of National Health Expenditure (NHE) data • [Get the data](#) • [PNG](#)

Partnership: KFF
Health System Tracker

Total national health expenditures as a percent of Gross Domestic Product, 1970-2023

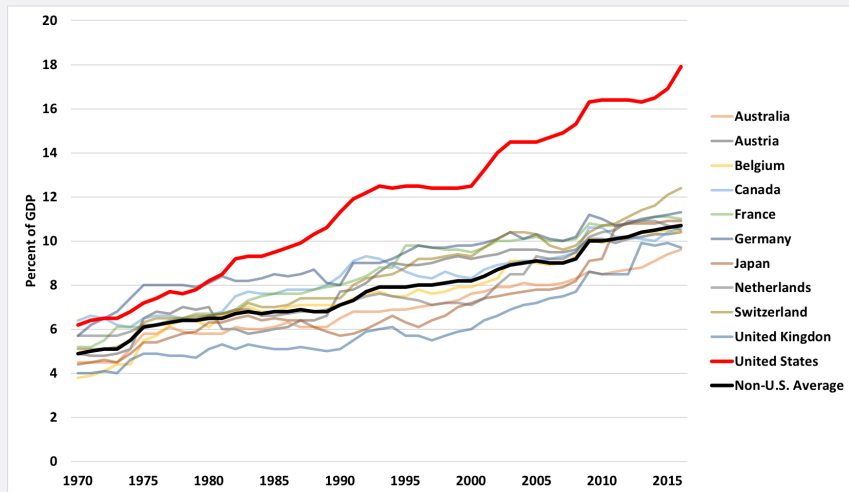


Source: KFF analysis of National Health Expenditure (NHE) data • [Get the data](#) • [PNG](#)

Partnership: KFF
Health System Tracker

International Spending Comparison

● Total Health Expenditures as a Percent of GDP, 1970-2016



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

International Spending Comparison

TheUpshot

THE NEW HEALTH CARE

Medical Mystery: Something Happened to U.S. Health Spending After 1980

The spending began soaring beyond that of other advanced nations, but without the same benefits in life expectancy.



By Austin Frakt

May 14, 2018

Mr. Starr suggests that the high inflation of the late 1970s contributed to growth in health care spending, which other countries had more systems in place to control. Likewise, Mr. Cutler points to related economic events before 1980 as contributing factors. The oil price shocks of the 1970s hurt economic growth, straining countries' ability to afford health care. "Thus, all across the world, one sees constraints on payment, technology, etc., in the 1970s and 1980s," he said. The United States is not different in kind, only degree; our constraints were weaker.

International Spending Comparison

- Compared to other developed countries, the U.S. spends a disproportionate share of national income on health care. Is this a good thing or a bad thing?

International Spending Comparison

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- Depends on:

International Spending Comparison

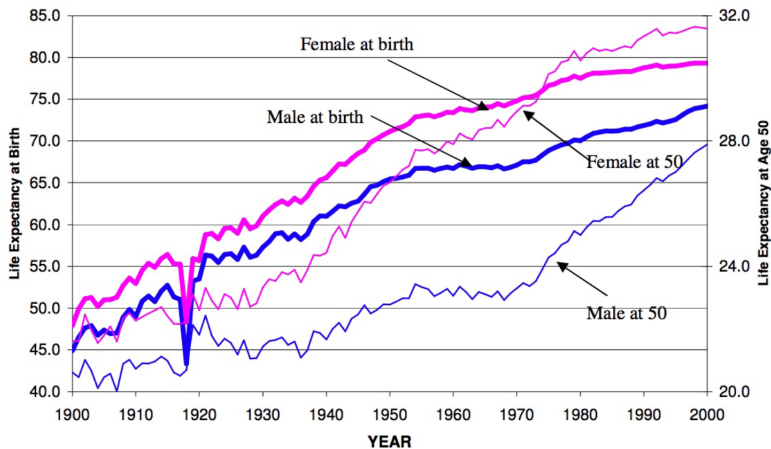
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International Spending Comparison

- Compared to other developed countries, the U.S. spends a disproportionate share of national income on health care. Is this a good thing or a bad thing?
- Depends on:
 1. Our values (e.g., education vs. health)
 2. The return on investment

Returns to Spending

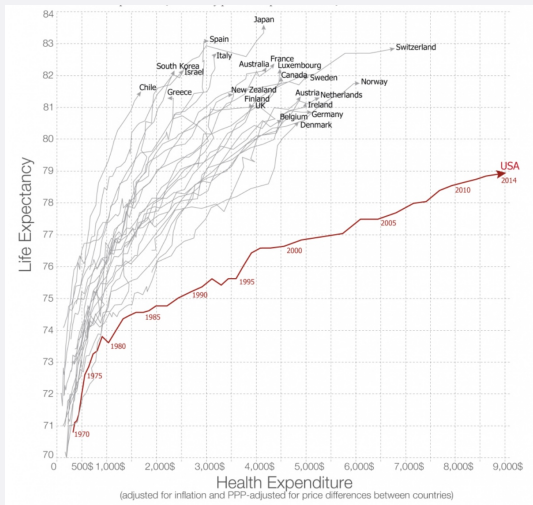
- Changes in U.S. Life Expectancy Over the 20th Century



Source: Murphy and Topel, 2006

Returns to Spending

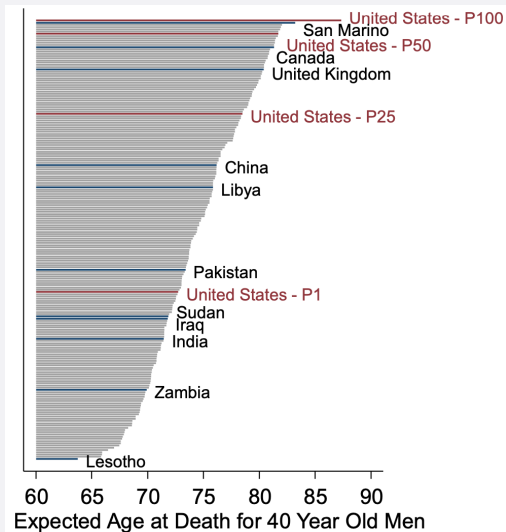
- Health Spending and Life Expectancy at Birth, 1970-2014



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Returns to Spending

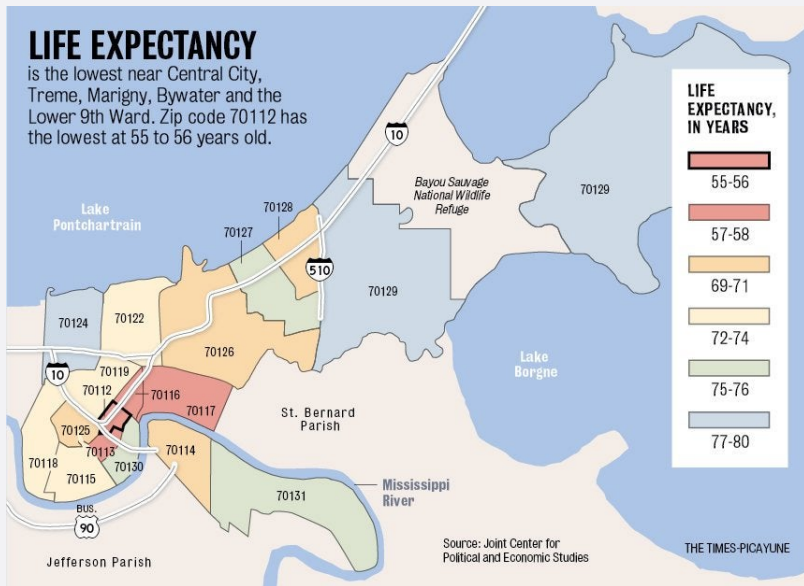
- U.S. Life Expectancies by Income Compared to Mean Life Expectancies Across Countries



Returns to Spending - Life Expectancy in NOLA

LIFE EXPECTANCY

is the lowest near Central City, Treme, Marigny, Bywater and the Lower 9th Ward. Zip code 70112 has the lowest at 55 to 56 years old.

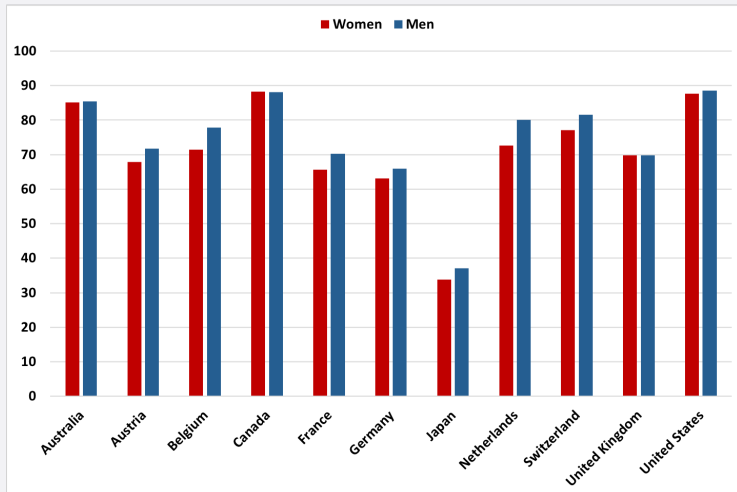


Health Spending

- What explains the high level of health care spending in the U.S.?

Health Spending - Population Health

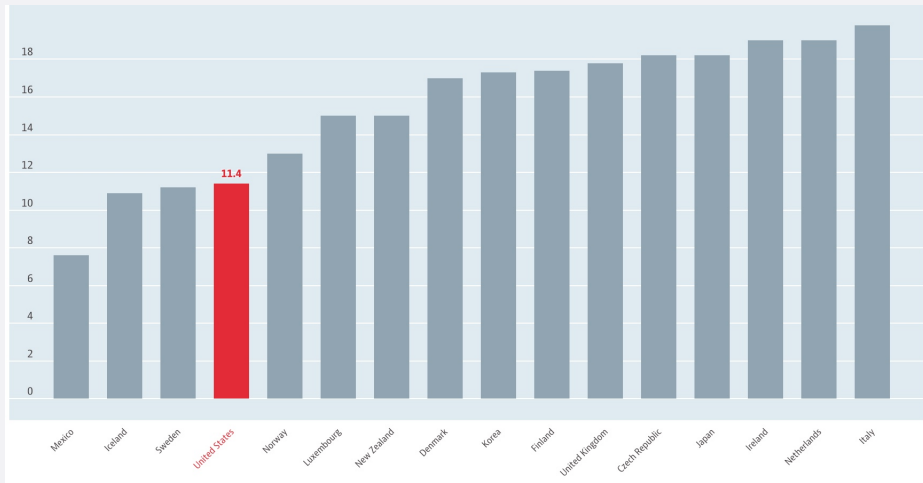
- Share of Population in Good or Very Good Health, 2015



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Health Behaviors

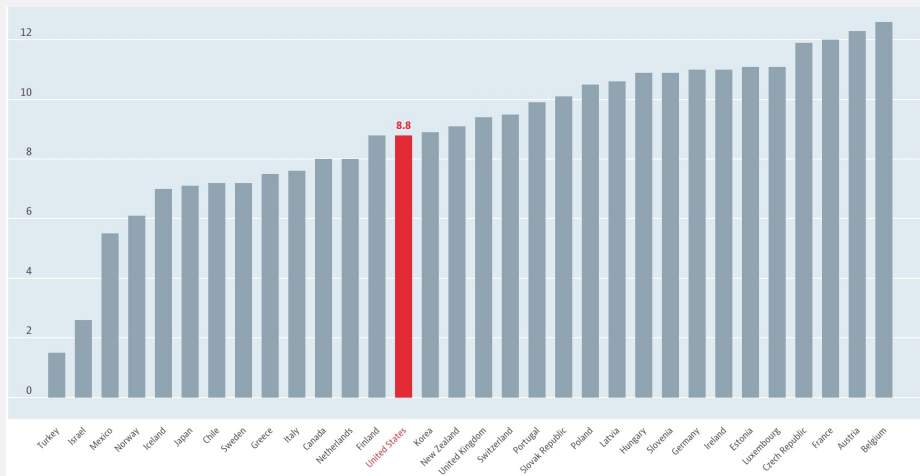
- Share of Population Age 15 or Older Who Smoke Daily, 2015



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Health Behaviors

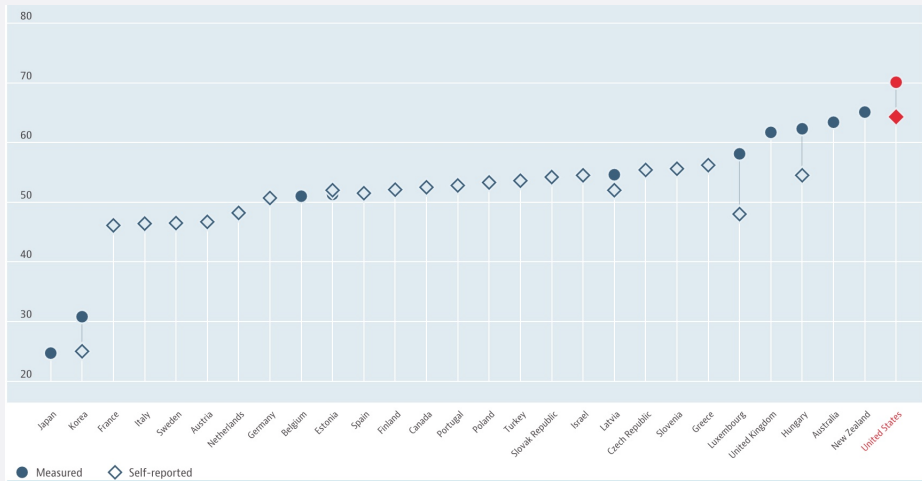
- Average Annual Liters of Alcohol Consumed Age 15 or Older, 2014



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Health Behaviors

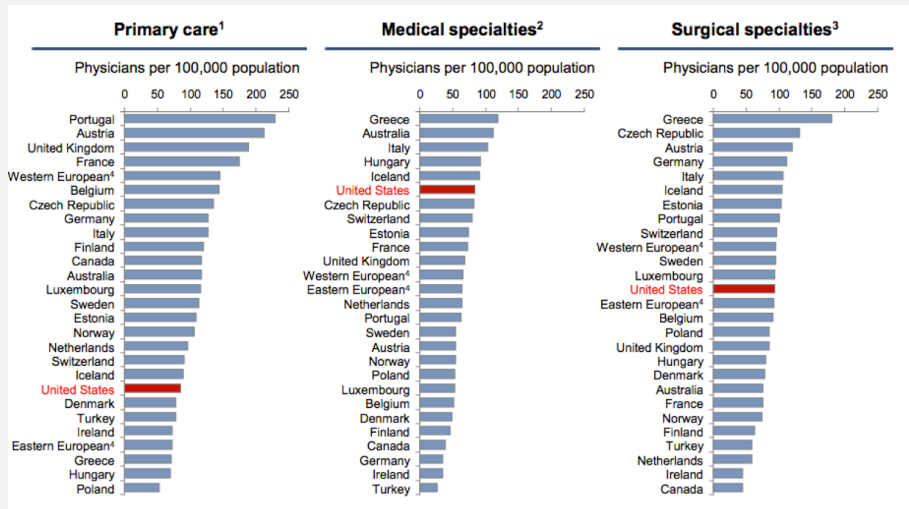
- Share of Population Age 15 or Older Obese/Overweight, 2014



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Health Care Inputs

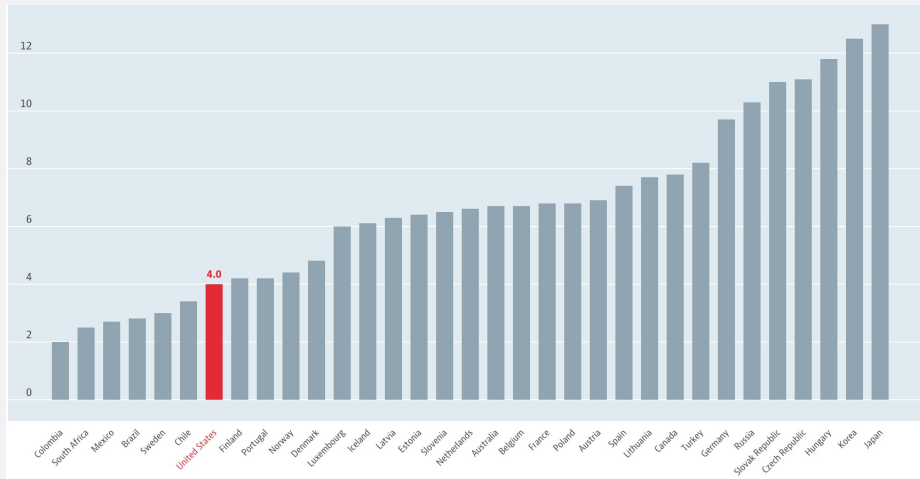
- Supply of Physicians, 2015



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Health Care Use

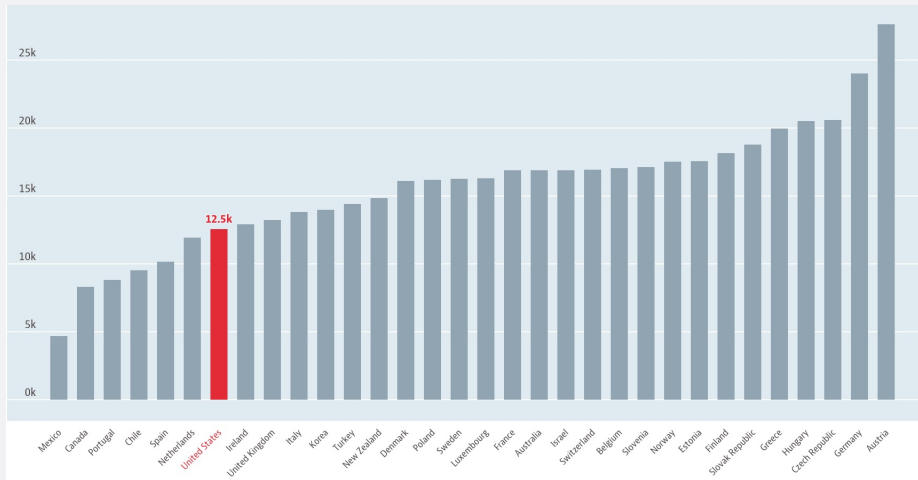
● Annual Number of Doctor Visits Per Capita, 2011



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

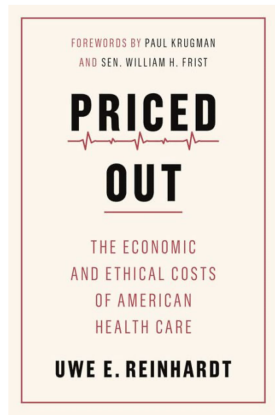
Health Spending - Health Care Use

● Hospital Discharges Per 100,000 Population, 2010



Source: OECD Health Statistics, 2017

Health Spending - Prices



Prices

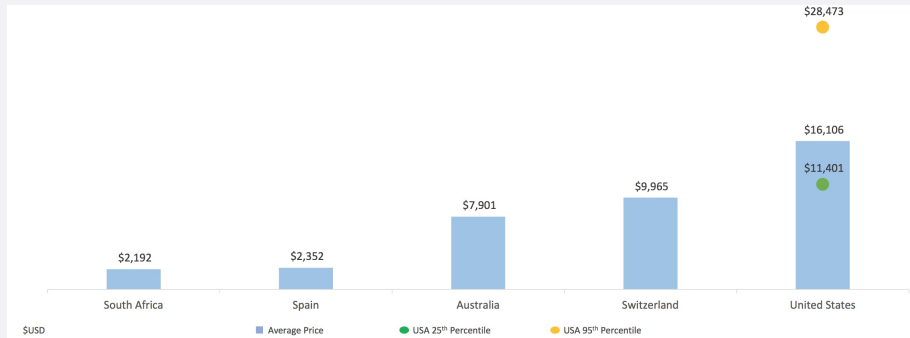
- Average Price Paid for Cataract Removal, 2015



Source: *International Federation of Health Plans 2015 Comparative Report*

Prices

- Average Price Paid for a C-Section Delivery, 2015



Source: *International Federation of Health Plans 2015 Comparative Report*

Prices

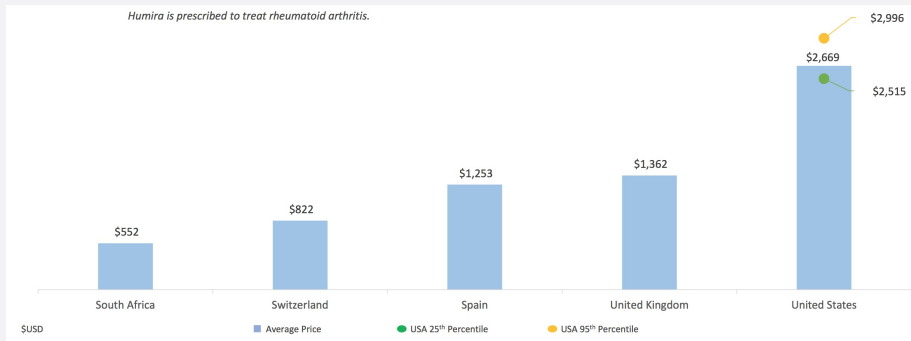
● Average Price Paid for a Knee Replacement, 2015



Source: International Federation of Health Plans 2015 Comparative Report

Prices

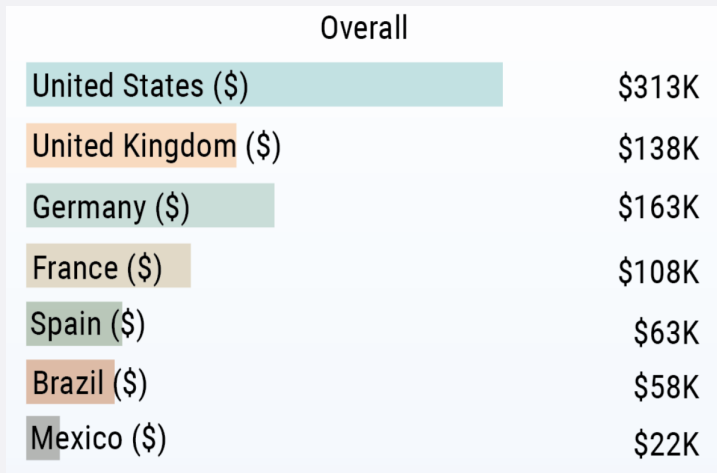
● Average Price Paid for a 28-day Supply of Humira, 2015



Source: International Federation of Health Plans 2015 Comparative Report

Health Spending - Health Care Inputs

- Average Physician Compensation (PPP-adjusted), 2019



Source: International Physician Compensation Report, 2019

State Health Policy Landscape

One Big Beautiful Bill: Implications for State Medicaid Programs



Why Medicaid?

Which comes closer to your view?

Medicaid is primarily a government health insurance program that helps people pay for health care

Medicaid is primarily a government welfare program

Total

61%

37%

Party ID

Democrats

79%

20%

Independents

60%

39%

Republicans

45%

54%

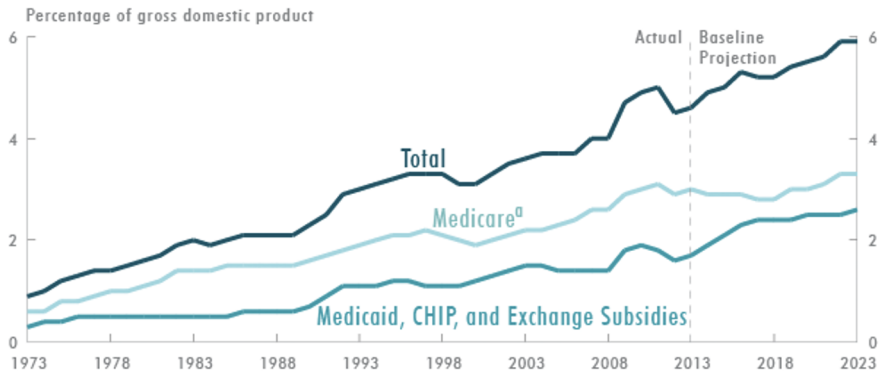
Note: See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (March 14-23, 2023) • [Get the data](#) • [Download PNG](#)

KFF

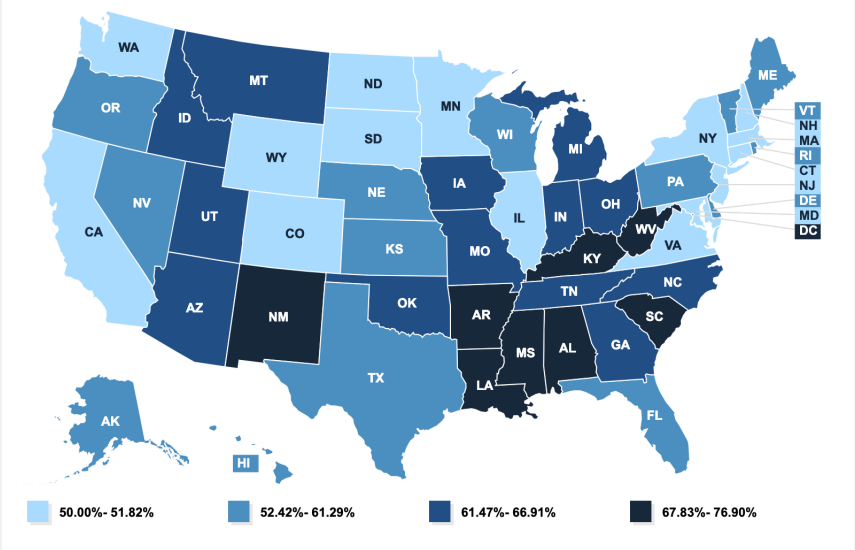
Why Medicaid?

Federal Spending on Major Health Care Programs, by Category, 1973 to 2023



Source: Congressional Budget Office

Medicaid Federal Medical Assistance Percentage (FMAP)

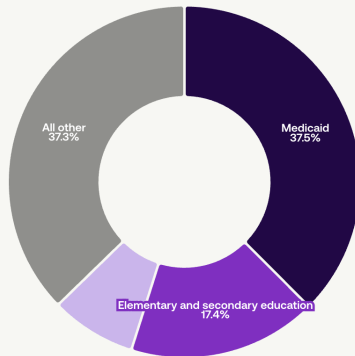


Louisiana State Budget

In FY 2022, Medicaid accounted for 37.5% of Louisiana state government spending.



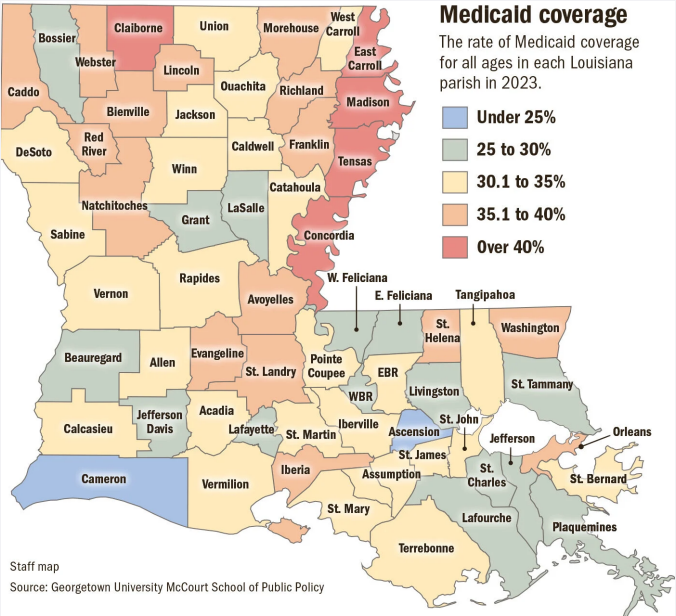
Shares of state government spending, including federally funded, by category



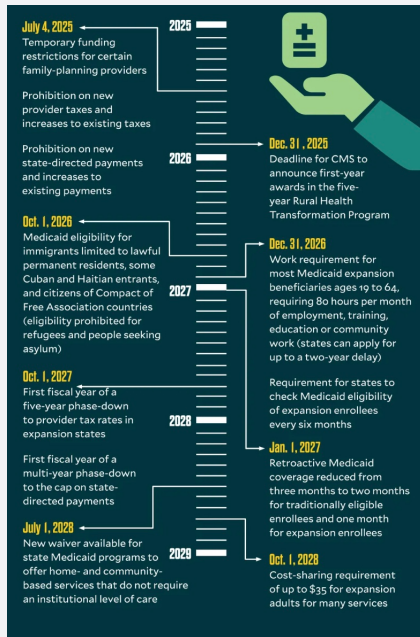
Source: Medicaid and CHIP Payment and Access Commission →

USA Facts

Louisiana Medicaid Enrollment



One Big Beautiful Bill: Implications for State Medicaid Programs

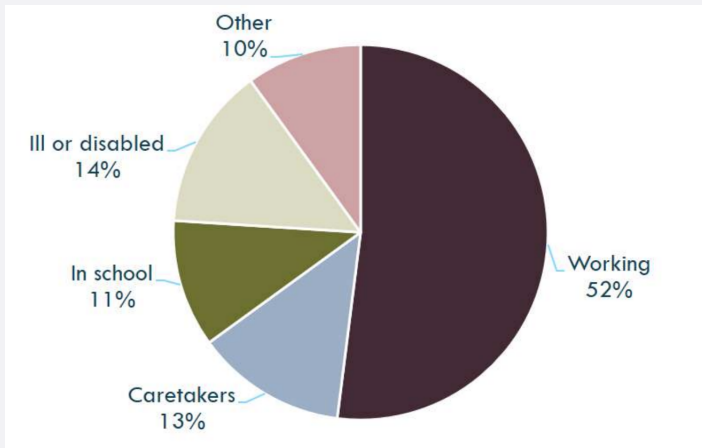


Medicaid Work Requirements



Medicaid Work Requirements

- Louisiana Adult Medicaid Enrollee Work Status



Source: Kaiser Family Foundation